

Tangy Braised Short Ribs

By Alison Roman

Total Time 4 hours, plus
seasoning

Rating ★ ★ ★ ★ ★ (2,439)

This bright, sweet and salty recipe for braised short ribs will work with bone-in or boneless meat, as long as the short ribs are thick (at least 1½ inch), and not the thinly sliced Korean style. Seasoning your meat with salt and pepper at least 24 hours in advance will greatly improve the flavor of the finished product. And, if you can spare an extra 24, making them a day ahead of serving will make them even better, with all that braising liquid flavoring the meat as it sits. Finishing with herbs and lemon are hardly a revelation in the braised meat department, but they are especially welcome here. The fresh lemon juice at the end transforms the braising liquid into a bright, brothy, spoonable sauce good enough to drink.

INGREDIENTS

Yield: 8 to 10 servings

5 pounds bone-in short ribs,
at least 1½-inch thick, cut
into single bone portions (or
3½ to 4 pounds boneless, at
least 1½-inch thick)
Kosher salt and freshly ground

PREPARATION

Step 1

Season short ribs with salt and pepper at least 1 hour
(at room temperature) and as much as 48 hours
(covered and refrigerated) in advance.

Step 2

Heat oven to 300 degrees. Heat 1 tablespoon oil in a
large Dutch oven over medium-high. Working in

black pepper
3 tablespoon vegetable or
canola oil
2 large yellow onions,
quartered
2 heads garlic, halved

crosswise
3 tablespoons honey
½ cup apple cider vinegar
½ cup soy sauce or tamari
4 cups chicken, beef or
vegetable broth
4 thyme sprigs
2 cups parsley, leaves and
tender stems, finely chopped
½ bunch chives, finely
chopped
Flaky sea salt
3 lemons, halved, for juicing

batches, sear short ribs until deeply golden brown on both large flat sides, 4 to 6 minutes per side. Transfer short ribs to a large plate or cutting board and drain all but about 2 tablespoons fat from the pot. Discard remaining fat. Repeat with remaining short ribs. Drain all fat from the pot and carefully wipe out. (No need to wash, just get rid of any scorched bits.)

Step 3

In the same pot over medium-high, heat remaining 2 tablespoons oil, and add onions and garlic. Cook, stirring occasionally, until the onions and garlic get a bit of color, 4 to 5 minutes. Add honey and cook, stirring until it starts to bubble furiously, turning a darker amber brown and sticking to the bottom of the pot as it cooks.

Step 4

Add vinegar and soy sauce, and, using a wooden spoon or spatula, scrape up the bits on the bottom of the pot. Bring to a strong simmer and cook to reduce by about half, 5 to 8 minutes. Add broth and thyme, and bring to a simmer. Season with salt and pepper and add short ribs back in, bone-side up, making sure they are as submerged in that braising liquid as possible. Cover the pot and place in the oven. Do not look at it or remove the lid for 3 hours. (Nothing bad will happen, promise.)

Step 5

After 3 hours, check the short ribs, they should be extremely tender and nearly falling apart, almost having the jiggly texture of a baked custard or Jell-O. (If not, continue roasting another 20 to 30 minutes.) Remove from oven.

Step 6

At this stage, you can remove the lid and using a spoon, carefully skim as much of the top layer of fat as possible. Increase oven temperature to 425 degrees, and return the pot to the oven, uncovered, to let the short ribs brown a bit on top and thicken the braising liquid a bit, another 35 to 45 minutes. (Alternatively, you can remove the short ribs from the oven, let them cool at room temperature and place in them in the fridge, overnight. When ready to serve, remove them from the fridge and using a spoon, scrape off the solidified fat on the top layer. Return the short ribs, covered, to a 325-degree oven until totally warmed through, 30 to 40 minutes. Remove the lid and increase temperature to 425 degrees, and continue to cook, uncovered, to let the short ribs brown a bit on top and reduce the braising liquid, another 35 to 45 minutes.)

Step 7

Meanwhile, combine parsley and chives in a small bowl and season with flaky salt.

Step 8

Remove the short ribs from the oven and serve straight from the pot or transfer them to a shallow bowl or plate with high sides, spooning the braising liquid over. Squeeze lemons over, letting the juice season the braising liquid. Sprinkle with parsley mixture before serving.

TIPS

While my preference is almost always bone-in for any cut of meat, this recipe will work with boneless ribs, too. (And a brisket, if you must: Add an hour to the cooking